

1.6 Issues and debates	Examples of issues and debates in social psychology: • Ethics (e.g. when researching obedience and prejudice, and also implications of findings in both areas). • Practical issues in the design and implementation of research (e.g. designing questionnaires and interviews and social desirability). • Reductionism (e.g. the risk of reductionism when drawing conclusions from social data). • Comparisons between ways of explaining behaviour using different themes (e.g. the two theories of prejudice: social identity and realistic conflict). • Psychology as a science (e.g. social desirability in questionnaires; issues of validity in questionnaires). • Culture and gender (e.g. whether prejudice and obedience are influenced by cultural factors or according to gender). • Nature-nurture (e.g. the role of personality in obedience compared with the role of the situation). • An understanding of how psychological understanding has developed over time (e.g. if using Burger's work replicating Milgram and comparing with Milgram's work; or looking at Tajfel's ideas and a contemporary study). • Issues of social control (e.g. reducing prejudice; or how people obey someone in authority/uniform). • The use of psychological knowledge in society (e.g. reducing conflict in society) • Issues related to socially-sensitive research (e.g. racism or cultural differences in social psychology).
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